

This was the kind of operation for which Farragut seemed to have been born, demanding what Gideon Welles called his “innate fearless moral courage.” When one of Farragut’s lead ships was sunk by a mine the whole venture almost foundered, but he led the squadron through the minefield, famously calling out, “Damn the torpedoes, full speed ahead!” He was also in the forefront of the subsequent naval battle in which CSS *Tennessee* was, with difficulty, overcome.

The hard-fought success at Mobile Bay carried Farragut’s reputation to unparalleled heights. He played no further significant part in the Civil War, exhaustion and poor health taking their toll, but he was much celebrated afterward. He acted as a pallbearer at Lincoln’s funeral, was promoted to full admiral, and was sent with a squadron across the Atlantic to be feted in European capitals.

Farragut was buried in Woodlawn Cemetery in the Bronx district of New York in 1870, after being accorded a funeral of memorable grandeur.